

8.2 Documentation format for final submission

1. Order and content of the thesis

1.1 Pretext (Preliminary pages)–It should contain the following headings:

1.1.1 Cover page:

This page should give information about title of the thesis, name of author, name of the institute, and month and year of thesis completion. For the convenience to easily locate the thesis while staked, information on title, author and year of graduation must appear in the side of bound thesis.

Information on font type, font size, font color, page margin and spacing between the lines is provided in the sample supplied as Appendix 1 and 2.

1.1.2 Title page:

Pagination should start from the title page, but should not appear in the page. All the information regarding this page is provided in Appendix 3.

1.1.3 Dedication (Optional):

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This is an optional page. Dedication should be brief and centered from all the ends on the page. No heading is used in the dedication page and number of this page should be “ii”. Dedication is not listed in the “Table of contents”. (See Appendix 4).

1.1.4 Declaration:

This section of thesis declares that your study is based on original research works, and related works on the topic being used in the thesis is duly acknowledged through proper citation and referencing. In addition, this section is also meant for taking responsibility by the student for any error and authenticity of the data used in the thesis (See Appendix 5). In the case there is dedication, pagination of this page would be “iii” otherwise it should be “ii”.

1.1.5 Recommendation

This is the recommendation to be made by the supervisor. It mentions that you have prepared and submitted the thesis through the supervision of your supervisor (See Appendix 6). By signing this page, It is expected supervisor assures the quality of your thesis to be sufficient enough to meet the requirement set by the University.

1.1.6 Certificate

This page certifies that you have successfully completed the thesis work and eligible for acceptance. This page is to be signed by the external examiner, supervisor (if there is co-supervisor, signed by co-supervisor as well) and Head of Department/Director/Principal of faculty/School/College (See Appendix 7). This page should be printed in college/school letter head with college/school official stamp

1.1.1 Acknowledgements

This section is to express gratitude to all the individuals or the institutions that helped you to successfully complete your research. Usually, supervisor and co- supervisor are acknowledged first followed by funding agencies, if any. Similarly, professors, classmates/ friends, staffs of the school/ college/ institute/ university, from whom you received guidance/suggestions/support, should also be acknowledged. In the case you have conducted field survey respondents should be acknowledged for their time consumed during the field survey as well as the information. You can also acknowledge your family members and relatives for their patience, support, dream whatsoever (See Appendix 8).

1.1.2 Abbreviations/Acronyms

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This section provides the list of abbreviation and acronyms used in the thesis along with their details. It should be presented in alphabetical order (See Appendix 15).

1.1.3 Units and conversions

This section provides the list of units and conversions, if applicable, used in the thesis along with their details. It should be presented in alphabetical order (Similar to Appendix 15).

1.1.4 Abstract

Abstract is compulsory. The heading ABSTRACT, in capital letters and bold font should be centered between the left and right margins, without punctuating or underlining. Four blank spaces should be maintained before starting the paragraph (See Appendix 9). Abstract should present a succinct account of the research. It should contain a statement of the research problem, methods, results, discussions, conclusions and recommendation, but in brief, limited within a page or two pages. Hence, it should be a concise reflection of the entire study so that it functions chiefly as a guide for students and scholars surveying research in their field. It should be written in simple English. Internal heading, citation(s), mathematical formula(s), diagrams/figure(s), table(s), and other illustrative material(s) must be avoided in abstract. The abstract should be concise within 300-350 words limit.

2. Keywords:

3-7 keywords based on the research should be kept in the page of abstract below the main text of the abstract.

2.1.1 Table of contents (with title and page number)

This page provides information to the readers about the composition of the whole thesis as well as location of different sections and sub-sections in the thesis. Hence, this section of the thesis should include the chapter, section and sub-section headings with appropriate page number (See Appendix 10). It should be placed next to the abstract sheet

1.1.1 List of tables (with title and page number)

This page provides information to the readers about the details of the tables provided in the thesis along with their location (page numbers). Numbering of tables should reflect on which chapter the table belongs to (See Appendix 11). e.g. *Table 3.4 refers to fourth table of chapter 3.*

1.1.2 List of figures (with title and page number)

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This page provides information to the readers about the details of the figures provided in the thesis along with their location (page numbers). Numbering of figures should reflect on which chapter the figure belongs to (See Appendix 12).

e.g. *Fig. 3.4 refers to fourth figure of chapter 3.*

1.1.3 List of plates/pictures (with titles and page number)

This page provides information to the readers about the details of the plates/pictures provided in the thesis along with their location (page numbers). Numbering of plates/pictures should reflect on which chapter the plate/picture belongs to (See Appendix 13). e.g. *Plate 3.4 refers to fourth plate of chapter 3.*

1.1.4 List of appendices (with titles and page number)

This page provides information to the readers about the details of the appendices provided in the thesis along with their location (page numbers). Its numbering can be done in normal sequence (See Appendix 14).

2. Chapter 1 INTRODUCTION

This chapter should discuss the background of the research issues being dealt, statement of the problem, research questions, research objectives, significance/rationale of the study, and scope and limitation of the study. Introduction must revolve around the central research issue.

1.1 Background

Brief background of the issues should be discussed under the background section. It should be done in the form of brief literature review of related literatures, which is essential to build statement of the problem, research question, and research objectives in the later part of INTRODUCTION chapter.

1.2 Statement of the problem

This section must indicate what the problem is, why and how it is a problem. Similarly, necessity to conduct the research should also be discussed. It should be supported by data or evidences. This section should be well connected with background section and as brief as possible.

1.3 Research questions

Based on the statement of the problem research question should be formulated.

Research questions should clearly state what type of answers the research is looking for.

1.4 Research objectives

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This section should clearly mention what you want to achieve from the research.

Usually, objective is presented as general objective and specific objectives. The general objective of research should be only one and should be in line with the title. To meet the general objective, several specific objectives could be set.

Specific objectives should be in line with research questions and are more or less equal in numbers of research questions.

1.5 Significance/Rationale of the study

The importance of the proposal research should be stated in this section, in terms of potential beneficiaries & the way they will be benefitted. The section should focus on justifying the topic of the proposed research.

CHAPTER 2 LITERATURE REVIEW

Literature review is basically a survey of published materials on the topic of the interest authored by accredited scholars and researchers. It is quite important to uncover what is already known in the body of knowledge prior to initiating any research (Hart, 1998). Hence, it is a crucial endeavor for any academic research in theoretical and conceptual progress (Shaw, 1995 and, Webster and Watson, 2002). Thus, it helps to situate your research in the context of what is already known about the topic and find the gap that your research will bridge.

Chapter 3: METHODOLOGY

This chapter includes the discussion about the way you conducted your thesis research in order to meet the objectives. The methodology should be summarized in the form of block diagram /flowchart. Selected methodology should be discussed in details along with the justification of selecting the methodology. Each method used in the thesis should be directly and specifically linked with the research objectives. It should include research design, research approaches study area, study population, sample selection (sample selection methods), sample size, methods of data collection (Key Informant Interview, Focused Group Discussion, questionnaire survey, modeling, observation, measurement) and data analysis approach & tools.

CHAPTER 4 : RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This section should present the findings of the study in logical sequences in line with the specific objectives. Presentation of data and facts should be explained regarding plausibility and compared with data from similar studies.

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Conclusion is an integration of various issues covered in the body of the thesis.

Conclusion includes noting any implications resulting from the discussion and making policy recommendation as well as the need for further research. Hence, the conclusion should be a logical ending to what has been previously discussed. It must

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pull together all parts of the argument and refer the reader back to the focus you have outlined in your introduction and to the central topic. Never present any new information in this section and never make generic conclusion which are not supported by the data/information in the text of the thesis. Thus, conclusion and recommendation of the study must be limited within the scope of the research.

REFERENCE

The arguments in the thesis should be supported by proper evidences. This needs to be done by referring to earlier publications such as patents, journals, books, reports, thesis and other materials. Hence, referencing gives credit to the authors or organizations for using their work in your thesis. It provides the reader with evidence of the breadth and depth of researchers reading and enables readers to locate the references easily. It is strongly recommended to follow the *IEEE referencing* format for the thesis submitted to University.

Note: *The students are strongly advised to familiarize themselves with the concept of plagiarism and should be below 20%.*